

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

Pam's parents struggled financially for most of her childhood, but throughout that time, she was blessed with a hardworking father who worked his way up from the mail room to a factory manager position for a phone company. While he always made a lower-middle-class income with just enough for their basic needs, Pam's father consistently taught her the value of hard work and self-sufficiency. Now retired and with a net worth of nearly \$2 million, Pam can still hear his voice echoing in her head, "Don't look to someone else to get something you can get for yourself . . . [and] don't work harder at getting *out* of work than actually working."

Those are lessons she learned and applied from a young age. With no money for college after high school, Pam went to work and saved for her own tuition. She started college at age twenty and worked on her degree steadily, as her income allowed, for eleven years before graduating at age thirty-one. During that time, she purchased a home, saved for retirement, got married, had three kids, and even paid for her husband's college degree. From age nineteen, Pam saved 10% of every dollar she earned, putting the power of compound interest—what she calls the "Eighth Wonder of the World"—to work for her. She lived below her means, never drove a new car, and stayed away from debt. When she lost a good bit of money in an unfortunate divorce from her first husband in her mid-forties, Pam picked herself back up and kept herself and her goals on track. Even though she was starting again from zero, she never gave up, never slowed down, and never stopped working for what she wanted to accomplish. Now remarried, Pam recently sold a company she built from the ground up and is enjoying a wonderful retirement filled with traveling, visiting art exhibitions, writing poetry, and going scuba diving whenever she wants. But don't think this retired millionaire has gotten lazy. She's still working to improve herself by taking college classes in her retirement. That's the thing about people who aren't scared to work hard. Even when they retire, they're still looking for ways to learn, work, and grow.
